



✿ THE FREE ONE-DAY GUIDE • SUMMER EDITION

Cádiz *in a day*

The oldest city in Western Europe, squeezed onto a peninsula you can walk end to end in twenty minutes. Here is exactly how I spend a perfect summer Sunday in it — hour by hour, no fluff.

BY LUCY RIVERO • @ITSLUCYINTHESOUTH

HOURLY BY HOURLY

The perfect *day*

9:30

Breakfast in Plaza de las Flores

Tostada, olive oil, tomato, café con leche. Sit on a terrace and watch the flower stalls open. This is the slowest meal of your day — enjoy it.

10:30

Walk the Campo del Sur

The golden-domed cathedral over the sea wall — the postcard you came for. Then get lost in *Barrio del Pópulo*, the medieval quarter with its three 13th-century arches and a Roman theatre (free entry).

12:00

Torre Tavira or the Mercado

The camera obscura at the old town's highest point shows you the whole city live. Or graze the Mercado Central — one of Spain's oldest covered markets.

13:30

Swim at La Caleta

The small beach between two castles. Locals arrive early; you arrive before the 2pm heat. Yes, it played Havana in a Bond film.

15:00

Lunch in La Viña

The fishermen's quarter. Order tortillitas de camarones and whatever the blackboard says. Then respect the *sobremesa* — nobody leaves the table before 5.

18:00

Shade under the giant ficus

Alameda Apodaca: century-old trees, tiled benches, sea breeze. The city's favourite place to do absolutely nothing.

20:00

Helado + paseo marítimo

Ice cream in hand, Playa Victoria's promenade under golden light. Everyone walks. Nowhere to go. That's the point.

21:30

Sunset at the castle walkway

The stone causeway to Castillo de San Sebastián, off La Caleta. Atlantic sunsets here go full fire. Stay till the last light.



Eat like a *gaditana*

Tortillitas de camarones

tor-tee-YEE-tas deh ka-ma-RO-ness

Lace-thin shrimp fritters, crisp at the edges, eaten too hot. The dish Cádiz is proudest of — and right to be.

Where: El Faro de Cádiz, in La Viña

Pescaíto frito

pes-ka-EE-to FREE-to

A paper cone of just-fried fish — cazón en adobo (marinated dogfish) is the local move. Eat it standing, walking, however.

Where: Freiduría Las Flores, Plaza de las Flores

Chicharrones especiales

chee-cha-RO-ness

Thin-sliced crispy pork with lemon and salt, served on waxed paper in a bar that hasn't changed in decades.

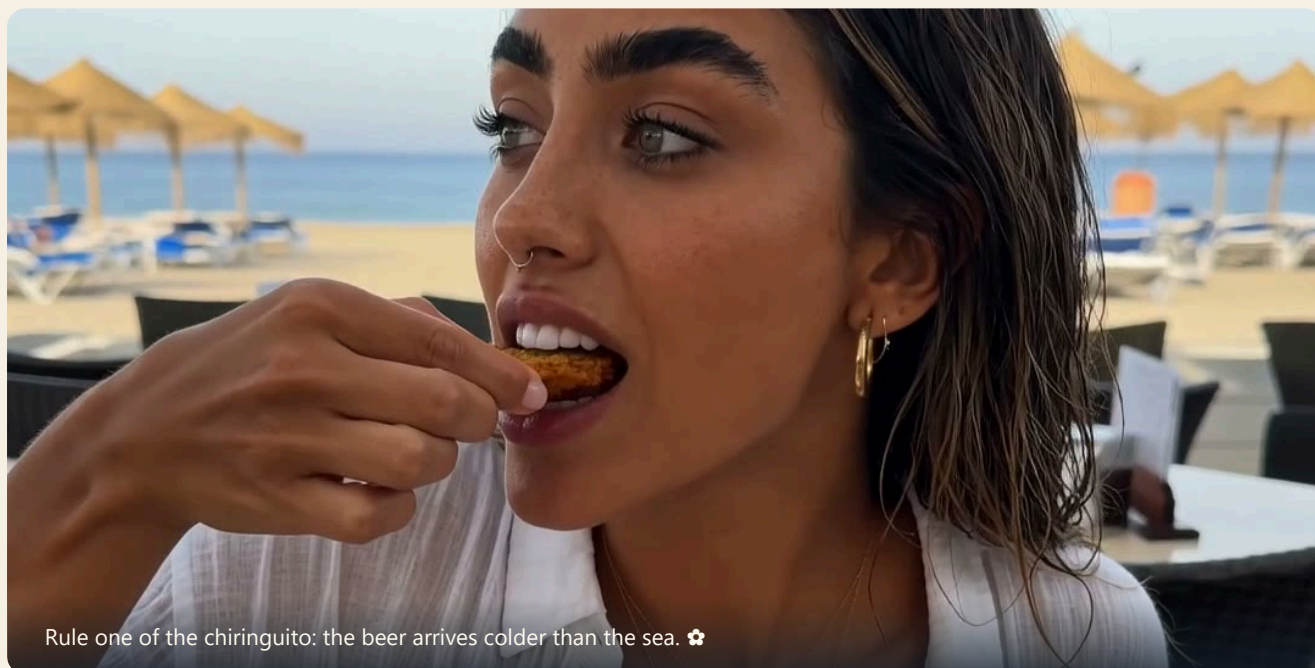
Where: Casa Manteca, the soul of La Viña

Atún de almadraba

ah-toon deh al-ma-DRA-ba

Wild bluefin tuna caught off this coast with a 3,000-year-old technique. In season, order it barely seared. Trust me.

Where: any blackboard that says "almadraba"



Rule one of the chiringuito: the beer arrives colder than the sea. 🌸

Drink like a local: skip the sangría. Order a *tinto de verano* (red wine + lemon soda, over ice) — half the price, twice the summer. With fried fish, a very cold *caña*. And if you see *manzanilla* on the menu, that's the bone-dry sherry from just up the coast. Say yes.



KNOW BEFORE YOU GO

Local *survival kit*

1 Check the wind, not the forecast

Two winds rule this city: *poniente* (cool, from the ocean — perfect beach day) and *levante* (hot, gusty, sand in your teeth). Levante day? Choose La Caleta, it's the sheltered one.

2 The 2–5pm shutdown is real

Shops close, streets empty, the city naps. Don't fight it — that's what the long lunch and the shaded Alameda are for.

3 Beach flags are law

Green = swim. Yellow = caution, feet on the ground. Red = admire the Atlantic from your towel. Lifeguards here don't negotiate.

4 Dinner starts at 21:30

Show up at 19:00 and you'll dine alone with the waiter setting tables. Have the helado, do the paseo, watch the sunset — then eat.

5 It's older than Rome. By a lot.

Phoenicians founded Gadir over 3,000 years ago. When you lean on a wall, ask yourself what century it's from. Nobody knows for sure.

6 Carnaval never fully leaves

Cádiz is Spain's capital of satire — its February Carnaval is legendary, and the humour stays all year. If a stranger makes you laugh, that's just Tuesday.

✿ **Lucy's golden rule:** when the levante blows, the old town is your friend — those narrow shaded streets were engineered for exactly this, five centuries before air conditioning.

Say it like a *local*

Cádiz

KAH-deeth

Not "KAY-diz". The soft *th* at the end is the whole password.

¡Quillo! / ¡Quilla!

KEE-yo / KEE-ya

The all-purpose gaditano greeting — from *chiquillo*, "kid". Friend, stranger, waiter: everyone is quillo.

Mi arma

mee AR-ma

"My soul" (*mi alma*), Andalusian edition. A term of endearment you'll earn by the second day.

Una cañita

OO-na ka-NYEE-ta

A small, ice-cold draft beer. The diminutive matters — it means you'll be having several.

Sobremesa

so-breh-MEH-sa

The hour(s) of talk after a meal ends. No English word for it — because it's not a habit, it's a philosophy.

¿Me cobras?

meh KO-bras

"Can I pay?" — said to the bartender with eye contact and a smile. No waving, no snapping. Ever.

One last thing 🌸 This guide fits in one day, but Cádiz doesn't. If you have a second morning: coffee at the market, a walk through the Genovés park, and the ferry across the bay to El Puerto de Santa María for one more plate of fried fish. You didn't hear it from me.



See you *in the south*

If this guide helps you, tag me when you go — I read everything, and nothing makes me happier than seeing my city through your eyes. Send me a message with your dates and I'll tell you what's on that week.

✿ [@itslucyinthelouth](#)